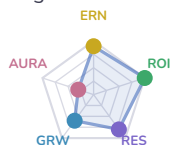


Career comparison — comparing 4 schools • As of May 09, 2026

Residency: Miami • Registered nurses: in-state | California: in-state | Miami • Registered nurses: in-state | Harvard: in-state

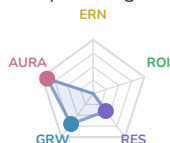
Miami Dade College

Registered nurses



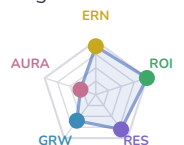
California Institute of Technology

Aerospace engineers



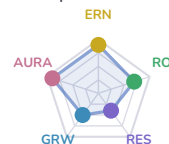
Miami Dade College

Registered nurses



Harvard University

Computer network support specialists



STATS AT A GLANCE

Stat	Miami • Registered nurses	California	Miami • Registered nurses	Harvard
ERN Earnings	9/10	—	9/10	9/10
ROI Return on Investment	10/10	—	10/10	7/10
RES AI Resilience	8/10	4/10	8/10	4/10
GRW Growth	6/10	7/10	6/10	5/10
AURA Brand Gravity	3/10	9/10	3/10	9/10

COST & ROI

	Miami • Registered nurses	California	Miami • Registered nurses	Harvard
4-year cost	\$50,140	\$334,392	\$50,140	\$331,368
Modeled debt	\$25,070	\$167,196	\$25,070	\$165,684
Year-1 peer band	\$32,935 – \$62,573	\$60,121 – \$69,541	\$32,935 – \$62,573	\$46,984 – \$65,661
Year-1 program median	\$73,541 ↑	\$134,830*	\$73,541 ↑	\$140,072 ↑
Debt-to-earnings (yr-1)	68%	—	68%	237%

* Program-median Year-1 earnings unavailable for this school; figure shown is the career-level mid-career wage (national OEWS median) as a reference. Excluded from the Year-1 leader highlight.

CAREER RISK PROFILE

Risk Factor	Miami • Registered nurses	California	Miami • Registered nurses	Harvard
AI displacement risk	LOW	ELEVATED	LOW	ELEVATED
Debt burden	LOW	Insufficient data	LOW	HIGH
Job market outlook	LOW	LOW	LOW	MODERATE
Burnout risk	MODERATE	MODERATE	MODERATE	MODERATE
Earnings ceiling	MODERATE	ELEVATED	MODERATE	ELEVATED

WHERE EACH SCHOOL PULLS AHEAD

Miami Dade College — no clear leader on these factors; trade-offs are even.

California Institute of Technology — leads on Growth.
 Miami Dade College — no clear leader on these factors; trade-offs are even.
 Harvard University — leads on Year-1 earnings.

SCHOOL PROFILE

	Miami · Registered nurses	California	Miami · Registered nurses	Harvard
Type	Public	Private nonprofit	Public	Private nonprofit
State	FL	CA	FL	MA
Residency	in-state	in-state	in-state	in-state
Major	Registered Nursing, Nursing Administrat...	Mechanical Engineering.	Registered Nursing, Nursing Administrat...	Computer Science.
Career	Registered nurses	Aerospace engineers	Registered nurses	Computer network support specialists

COST BREAKDOWN

	Miami · Registered nurses	California	Miami · Registered nurses	Harvard
Tuition (annual, residency-aware)	\$2,838	\$63,255	\$2,838	\$59,076
Room & board (on-campus)	—	\$19,503	—	\$20,374
Net price (annual avg, after aid)	\$5,929	\$18,902	\$5,929	\$16,816
Cost of attendance (annual, residency-aware)	\$12,535	\$83,598	\$12,535	\$82,842
4-year cost (residency-aware)	\$50,140	\$334,392	\$50,140	\$331,368
Modeled total debt	\$25,070	\$167,196	\$25,070	\$165,684

CAREER BRANCHES

Where each path can lead next — top related careers and how their stats compare against the starting role.

Miami · Registered nurses	California	Miami · Registered nurses	Harvard
Nurse Practitioners ERN +2 · ROI +1 · RES -1 · GRW +4 Psychiatrists RES -1 · GRW +1 Paramedics ERN -2 · ROI -1 · GRW +1	Aerospace Engineering and Operations Te... ERN -2 · ROI -1 · RES +1 Electro-Mechanical and Mechatronics Tec... ERN -2 · ROI -1 · RES +1 · GRW -2 Avionics Technicians ERN -2 · ROI -1 · RES +2	Nurse Practitioners ERN +2 · ROI +1 · RES -1 · GRW +4 Psychiatrists RES -1 · GRW +1 Paramedics ERN -2 · ROI -1 · GRW +1	Computer Network Architects ERN +2 · ROI +1 · RES +1 · GRW +3 Network and Computer Systems Administra... ERN +2 · ROI +1 · RES +1 · GRW -2 Computer User Support Specialists ERN -1 · GRW -1

GEMMA'S VERDICT

Miami Dade College focuses on getting you into the workforce quickly with very little debt. You optimize for financial safety because your starting salary for Registered nurses covers your \$25,070 in student loans in about one year. The tradeoff is that the school name carries less weight on a resume and you might hit a career ceiling sooner than in other fields. California Institute of Technology optimizes for high prestige and a high median salary of \$134,830 as an Aerospace engineer. This path offers a growing job market but requires you to take on a large amount of debt, totaling \$167,196. You are trading financial ease and protection against automation for a powerful brand name and a high-level technical career. Harvard University optimizes for extreme brand recognition and a very high starting salary of \$140,072 for Computer network support specialists. However, the cost of the degree is very high, leaving you with \$165,684 in debt that takes longer to pay back relative to your earnings. You also face a higher risk of your specific job tasks being changed by AI technology. Your decision comes down to whether you want to prioritize immediate financial stability or invest heavily in a high-prestige name for long-term career potential.

Big Choice

Low Debt or High Prestige

Nursing at Miami Dade College costs only \$25,070 in debt compared to \$167,196 for Caltech or \$165,684 for Harvard.

Pros & Cons by school

Miami · Registered nurses	California	Miami · Registered nurses	Harvard
PROS + Total debt of \$25,070 is \$142,126 lower than the Caltech aerospace path. + Starting salary of \$73,541 covers the \$5,929 annual cost in one year. CONS – Median salary of \$93,600 is \$41,230 less than aerospace engineers. – The school brand signal is a 3/10 compared to Harvard's 9/10.	PROS + Median salary of \$134,830 is \$41,230 higher than registered nurses. + The school carries a 9/10 brand signal compared to Miami Dade's 3/10. CONS – Total debt of \$167,196 is \$142,126 more than the nursing path. – AI resilience is 4/10, which is lower than the nursing 8/10.	PROS + Total debt of \$25,070 is \$140,614 less than the Harvard path. + Starting salary of \$73,541 is higher than the \$140,072 Harvard specialist start. CONS – Median salary of \$93,600 is \$41,230 less than aerospace engineers. – The school brand signal is a 3/10 compared to Harvard's 9/10.	PROS + Starting salary of \$140,072 is \$66,529 more than nursing graduates. + The school carries a 9/10 brand signal compared to Miami Dade's 3/10. CONS – Total debt of \$165,684 is \$140,614 more than the nursing path. – Cost is 2.4x annual salary, which is harder than the nursing ROI.

In ten years

By 30, Miami Dade nurses earning \$93,600 will have cleared debt and likely be Nurse Practitioners with \$748,800 in total earnings. Caltech aerospace engineers will have earned \$1,078,640 but still be paying off heavy loans while working as Mechanical Engineers. Harvard specialists will have earned \$586,720, likely working as Network Architects while managing massive debt.

Sit with this

How much is the Harvard or Caltech name worth to you if you are still paying off \$165,000 in debt while a Miami Dade nurse is already saving for a house?